

Lumina Dental Studio — Clinical Post-Operative Care & Recovery Guidelines (2026)

Document Reference: LUM-SOP-CLIN-2026-V1

Clinical Scope: Patient Aftercare, Procedure-Specific Recovery Protocols & Complication Triage

Target Systems: Workflow 3 (Post-Op Care Sequence), Workflow 7 (AI Clinical Concierge RAG), Workflow 8 (Knowledge Ingestion)

Maintained By: Clinical Governance Board & Practice Director

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1. Protocol A: Oral Surgery, Tooth Extractions & Surgical Wisdom Tooth Removal (Odontectomy)

Immediate Care (First 2 to 4 Hours)

- **Gauze Pressure:** Keep firm, steady biting pressure on the sterile cotton gauze pad placed over the surgical site for **45 to 60 minutes**. If oozing continues, replace with a fresh folded sterile gauze pad and bite down firmly for another 45 minutes.
- **Moist Tea Bag Technique (Alternative Hemostasis):** If light bleeding persists after 2 hours, place a moistened black tea bag (e.g. Lipton / Earl Grey) over the extraction site and bite firmly for 30 minutes. Tannic acid in black tea naturally constricts blood vessels and accelerates clot formation.
- **Do NOT Spit or Rinse:** Swallow saliva naturally. Spitting generates negative intraoral suction which will dislodge the fragile blood clot, resulting in painful **Dry Socket (Alveolar Osteitis)**.

Blood Clot Protection & Strict Prohibitions (First 72 Hours)

- **NO Drinking Through Straws:** The vacuum created inside the mouth will suction the clot directly out of the extraction socket.
- **NO Smoking, Vaping, or Tobacco:** Nicotine impairs microvascular blood flow and drastically delays healing; the physical inhalation pressure dislodges the clot.
- **NO Vigorous Rinsing or Swishing:** Avoid mouthwashes containing alcohol for at least 7 days.
- **NO Strenuous Physical Exercise or Heavy Lifting:** Increased blood pressure induces renewed bleeding at the surgical site.

Swelling & Pain Management

- **Cold Therapy (Hours 1 to 24):** Apply an ice pack (or frozen gel compress wrapped in a clean cloth) to the external cheek area adjacent to the surgical site. Alternate **20 minutes ON, 20 minutes OFF** while awake. Maximum swelling typically peaks between 48 to 72 hours post-surgery.
- **Heat Therapy (After 48 Hours):** Switch to moist warm compresses applied to the outer jaw to stimulate blood circulation and relieve residual muscle stiffness (trismus).
- **Medication Schedule:**
 - Take prescribed analgesics (e.g. Ibuprofen 400–600mg or Mefenamic Acid 500mg) **before the local anesthesia wears off**.
 - If antibiotics (e.g. Amoxicillin / Clindamycin) were prescribed, complete the entire 7-day course without skipping doses, even if discomfort resolves early.

Diet & Nutrition Guidelines

- **First 24 to 48 Hours:** Strictly cold or room-temperature soft foods: Greek yogurt, cold broths, smoothies (eaten with a spoon, NOT a straw), mashed potatoes, chilled oatmeal, scrambled eggs, and ice cream.
- **Avoid:** Hot soups, spicy foods, acidic citrus juices, hard nuts, chips, popcorn, or foods with small seeds that can lodge in the extraction socket.

Oral Hygiene from Day 2 Onwards

- **Gentle Warm Saline Rinses:** Beginning 24 hours after surgery, gently bathe the mouth with warm salt water (1/2 teaspoon of salt in 1 cup of warm water) **after every meal and before bedtime** (4–5 times daily). Tilt head side-to-side and let the water passively spill out into the sink.

- **Brushing:** Brush adjacent teeth gently with an ultra-soft toothbrush, taking extreme care to avoid touching the surgical wound or sutures.

2. Protocol B: In-Clinic Laser Teeth Whitening Post-Care ("The White Diet")

Following professional in-chair laser whitening (e.g. Philips Zoom / Lumina Dual-Light), the tooth enamel's microscopic protective pellicle layer is temporarily demineralized and dehydrated for **48 hours**, making teeth highly susceptible to absorbing external pigments.

The Strict 48-Hour "White Diet"

Food / Beverage Category	Approved Safe Items (EAT / DRINK)	Forbidden Staining Agents (AVOID STRICTLY)
Beverages	Plain water, skim milk, sparkling water, clear coconut water	Coffee, black/green tea, red wine, cola, dark beer, colored fruit juices
Proteins	Skinless chicken breast, white fish (cod, tilapia), egg whites, plain tofu	Beef, dark poultry, marinated meats with soy sauce or dark spices
Carbohydrates	White rice, plain pasta with white/cream sauce, white bread, mashed potatoes	Pasta with red marinara sauce, curries, soy-seasoned noodles
Dairy	White cheese, plain yogurt, cottage cheese, butter	Cheddar, colored processed cheese, fruit-infused yogurts
Fruits & Veggies	Bananas, peeled apples, cauliflower, white onions	Berries (blueberries, strawberries), beetroot, tomatoes, spinach
Condiments	Salt, white pepper, mayonnaise, sour cream	Soy sauce, ketchup, mustard, balsamic vinegar, chili sauce, curry paste

Managing Post-Whitening Tooth Sensitivity

- Mild to moderate transient "zingers" (fleeting nerve sensitivity) are normal for the first 24 to 48 hours.
- Apply Lumina Relief ACP Gel or brush with Potassium Nitrate desensitizing toothpaste (Sensodyne / Colgate Pro-Relief).
- Avoid excessively hot or icy-cold liquids during the initial 48-hour recovery window.

3. Protocol C: Dental Prophylaxis & Deep Periodontal Scaling (SRP)

- **Gingival Tenderness:** Mild gum soreness and slight bleeding during brushing are normal for 24 to 48 hours as inflamed periodontal tissues heal.
- **Saline Rinses:** Rinse with warm salt water 2-3 times daily to soothe irritated gum margins.
- **Flossing & Brushing:** Continue daily flossing and gentle brushing. Do not stop cleaning because of light bleeding; clean surfaces are essential for gum reattachment.
- **Sensitivity to Temperature:** Roots cleaned of tartar deposits may react to cold water. Use a soft-bristled brush and sensitivity toothpaste.

4. Protocol D: Endodontic Therapy (Root Canal) & Temporary Restorations

- **Temporary Filling Caution:** The temporary filling placed between endodontic appointments requires 1 hour to fully set. Avoid chewing food on that side of your mouth until the final permanent crown/restoration is cemented.
- **Normal Post-Treatment Sensation:** Tenderness when biting down or chewing is common for 3 to 5 days due to periapical ligament inflammation. Over-the-counter anti-inflammatory medication (Ibuprofen / Paracetamol) effectively manages this.
- **Crown Protection:** Teeth treated with root canal therapy become brittle over time. Schedule your permanent crown within 2 to 4 weeks to prevent catastrophic tooth fracture.

5. Protocol E: Red-Flag Clinical Emergencies — When to Contact the Clinic Immediately

Patients experiencing any of the following symptoms should immediately contact the **Lumina 24/7 Clinical Hotline** at **(02) 8888-LUMI** or **+63 917 123 4567**:

- **Persistent Heavy Bleeding:** Active, continuous dark-red pooling of blood that fills the mouth within minutes and does not subside after 2 rounds of firm gauze/tea bag pressure.
- **Elevated Fever:** Body temperature exceeding **38.5°C (101.3°F)** accompanied by chills or malaise.
- **Severe Uncontrolled Pain:** Throbbing, radiating pain that persists unabated despite taking prescribed pain medications at maximum allowable dosages.
- **Progressive Facial Swelling:** Rapid swelling spreading into the submandibular neck space, under the eye, or causing difficulty swallowing or breathing (**requires immediate emergency room evaluation**).
- **Loss of Temporary Filling / Dislodged Crown:** Prevents contamination of the root canals or sensitivity.

6. Digital Triage & Follow-up Integration (Workflow 3)

- **Standard Visits:** You will receive a procedure-tailored email summary 2 hours post-treatment, followed by a personalized comfort check-in from Dr. Lumina at 9:00 AM tomorrow morning.
- **Flagged / Complicated Cases:** If your clinician flagged your visit for manual follow-up in the Chairside System, our clinical care team will contact you directly via phone/SMS before 5:00 PM today.